EXECUTIVE SUMMARY – Global Superstore Sales Performance

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This summary presents the findings from an interactive Power BI dashboard built on the Global Superstore dataset (2011–2014). The dashboard tracks total sales of **$12.64M**, profit of **$1.47M**, roughly **25,000 orders**, and an overall profit margin of **11.61%**.

Five key insights

1. **Growth is real and steady.** The line chart shows sales climbing from about $2M in 2011 to over $4M in 2014, the business more than doubled in four years.
2. **APAC and EU bring the most revenue, but profit is thin.** The market chart and matrix show large sales bars with small profit bars in those markets, while the US converts sales into profit more efficiently.
3. **Technology is the strongest category; Furniture is the weakest on profit.** Technology leads both sales and profit, while Furniture generates similar sales to Office Supplies but returns the least profit, sometimes negative.
4. **Deep discounts are eating the profit.** Orders carrying 60–80% discounts consistently show losses in the data, which is the main reason the overall margin sits at only 11.61%.
5. **Consumers drive revenue.** The donut chart shows the Consumer segment as the largest contributor, followed closely by Corporate, with Home Office the smallest.

Three business risks

1. **Selling at a loss**: discount-heavy Furniture and some Technology deals grow revenue but destroy profit.
2. **Weak margins in smaller markets** (Africa, Canada), where low sales volumes and shipping costs leave little profit.
3. **Discount dependency**: if competitors match our discounts, the already-thin 11.61% margin could collapse further.

Three opportunities

1. **Fixing the discount policy** can lift margin immediately without major volume loss.
2. **Scaling proven winners**:the top-10 profitable products (phones, copiers, binding systems) and Corporate bundles.
3. **Under-penetrated markets** (Africa, LATAM) offer growth room with the right product
4. mix and shipping strategy.

Five recommendations

1. **Cap discounts**: e.g., maximum 40% without approval, and no 60%+ discounts on low-margin products (evidence: losses cluster at high discounts).
2. **Reprice or bundle Furniture**: remove consistently loss-making items or pair them with profitable Office Supplies (evidence: category profit chart).
3. **Shift marketing spends toward high-return areas**: Technology in APAC and US markets (evidence: market and category charts).
4. **Review shipping costs** on loss-making orders and renegotiate carrier rates or adjust ship modes (evidence: high shipping costs on negative-profit orders).
5. **Make the dashboard a management habit**: review KPIs monthly with slicer-driven deep dives, and set a target to lift margin from 11.6% toward 14% within a year.